

VANTRO

GPS Tracking — How It Works

A plain-English explainer for installers

What this document is

This document explains exactly how Vantro tracks location while you're working. It is written for you, the installer. You should read it before using the app. If anything is unclear, ask your employer — and if they're not sure either, they can email us at aileen@applyscale8.com.

Nothing in this document is hidden. The app does exactly what's described here, and nothing more.

The short version

Here's exactly what's tracked, when, and why — no surprises.

Vantro records when you sign in, when you sign out, and periodic location pings while you're signed in. It's not a continuous trail — it's a series of check-ins so the system can verify you're on site and tell when your shift has ended.

Your shift ends in one of three ways: (1) you tap Sign out yourself, (2) you leave the job site earlier in the day — the app detects this and ends your shift automatically, or (3) if the app loses connection or crashes, the server catches it and closes the shift safely.

In the last 2 hours of your scheduled finish, leaving the site does NOT close your shift. The system assumes that's a lunch break, a parts run, or you finishing up early. Tap Sign out yourself, or the server will close it cleanly when you're done.

Outside your shift, the app does nothing. No location, no notifications, no background activity. When you're off the clock, it's off.

Why it exists: so your employer has a clean record for client invoicing and dispute resolution. Not surveillance. The same record protects you if a job is later disputed.

When tracking starts

Tracking starts only after you tap the Sign in button in the Vantro app, and only after the app confirms you are at the correct job site (or near enough to it, within the allowed distance set by your employer).

If you don't tap Sign in, no tracking happens. There is no automatic tracking based on your shift schedule. There is no tracking that runs in the background without your action. Tapping Sign in is the active step that turns it on.

When tracking stops

Tracking stops as soon as your shift ends. Your shift ends in one of three ways:

- You tap Sign out yourself.

- Earlier in the shift, if you leave the job site, the app detects this and ends your shift automatically. The time and location of exit are recorded.
- If the app loses connection, crashes, or your phone dies, a server-side safety net closes the shift cleanly within 30 minutes.

Important: in the last 2 hours of your scheduled finish time, leaving the site does NOT end your shift. This is intentional. The system assumes a lunch break, a quick parts run, or you finishing up early are all normal. The shift stays open until you tap Sign out or the server safely closes it.

There is also a hard cap of 12 hours from sign-in. If a shift is still open after 12 hours (you forgot to sign out and the app never reported you leaving), the server will close it. This is a safety guard, not a tracking feature.

What data is captured during a shift

While you are signed in to a shift, the app records:

- The time you tapped Sign in, and your GPS location at that moment (to confirm you're at the right job site).
- Periodic location pings while you're on site. These are check-ins, not a continuous trail — they let the system confirm you're still on site and detect when you've left.
- The time you tapped Sign out (or, if the app closed your shift automatically because you left the site, the time and location of that exit).
- Any diary entries, defect reports, photos, or receipts you submit during the shift, with the GPS location at the moment of submission.

What is NOT captured:

- A continuous, second-by-second trail of where you went.
- Your speed or driving route.
- Anything when you are not signed in to a shift.
- Your phone calls, messages, contacts, photos other than ones you choose to upload, or anything else on your device.

What the app does when you're not signed in

If you are not signed in to a shift, the app does not track your location. Not in the morning before you start. Not in the evening after you finish. Not on weekends. Not on days off. Not at any other point. Tracking is tied to being signed in — nothing else.

This is not a setting that can be changed. It is how the app is built.

Notifications

The app sends two and only two types of push notification:

- A reminder to sign in, sent in the 15 to 30 minutes before your scheduled shift start.
- A reminder to sign out, sent in the first 19 minutes after your scheduled shift finish if you haven't signed out yet.

That is the complete list. No marketing notifications. No "you went off site" alerts. No anything else.

Notifications themselves have a quiet window between 19:00 and 07:00 UTC. Even if the conditions above are met, no push will be sent during that window. (This only affects notifications — it does not affect tracking, because tracking is shift-scoped, not clock-scoped.)

How you can see your own data

You have full visibility of your own data inside the Vantro app. You can see your sign-in and sign-out times for every shift, and any diary entries, defects, or receipts you've submitted.

If you spot anything that looks wrong, raise it with your employer in the first instance. If you believe Vantro itself has made a mistake, you can email us at aileen@applyscale8.com and we will investigate.

Your rights under GDPR

You have legal rights over the personal data Vantro processes about you. These rights include:

- The right to see a copy of your data (a Subject Access Request).
- The right to have inaccurate data corrected.
- The right to ask for your data to be deleted, subject to legal and contractual constraints (for example, payroll and tax records that must be kept for compliance reasons).
- The right to object to how your data is being processed.
- The right to lodge a complaint with the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) at ico.org.uk.

To exercise any of these rights, contact your employer first. If they cannot resolve it, contact Vantro directly at aileen@applyscale8.com.

Why tracking exists at all

Vantro is built for installation businesses. The GPS data exists for three specific operational purposes:

- To prove on-site working hours for client invoicing. If a client queries an invoice, your employer can show the GPS audit trail rather than relying on memory.
- To create a clean audit trail if a defect or dispute arises after the job is complete. The app records that you (or another installer) signed in, completed the checklist, and signed out.
- To allow your employer to schedule and dispatch you efficiently — for example, knowing whether you have already arrived on site or whether you are still en route.

The purpose is operational. It is not surveillance. If you ever feel the system is being used to monitor you in a way that goes beyond what's described in this document, raise it with your employer and, if needed, with us directly.

Summary

Tracking only happens when you are signed in to a shift. It ends when you tap Sign out, when the app detects you've left the job site (earlier in the day), or when the server safety net catches an unended shift. If you are not signed in, the app captures nothing — any time of day. You can see all of your own data inside the app. You have legal rights under GDPR which you can exercise at any time.

If you have read this and you're still unsure about anything, ask. There are no trick questions in this document.

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